

Left with Right on Q

DELHI Although the Left maintains that its nuclear face-off with the Congress is exclusive and is making an effort to distance itself from the BJP, it is doing quite the opposite in another quarter. BJP and its NDA allies have threatened to bring a no-confidence motion in the Lok Sabha against the UPA Government for failing to nail Ottavio Quattrocchi. The Italian businessman was granted reprieve by an Argentinian court last week after Delhi failed to appeal for his extradition. CBI, it appears, did not have "enough evidence" to strengthen its case against Quattrocchi, who has always been believed to be the prime suspect in the Bofors pay-off case. The Argentinian court had given CBI almost a year to prepare its extradition request. "This is a shame," said the CPI(M).

Early last year, CPI(M) General Secretary Prakash Karat had report-



edly questioned Congress President Sonia Gandhi over the issue of Quattrocchi being allowed to reopen his frozen bank accounts in London. Sonia was said to have admitted her ignorance regarding CBI's handling of the case. In subsequent months, however, the issue was put to rest by the Left.

Prior to the furore over the nuclear deal, the Left's opposition to Quattrocchi's advantageous position had not been as pronounced as it has become today. Despite trying hard to distance itself from the BJP on the nuclear issue, they seem

LUCKY AGAIN: Quattrocchi to be making their displeasure on Quattrocchi's release quite apparent, along with that of the saffron party. Though it was only last year that the Left had castigated the previous BJP-led regime for being complacent in getting him, but suddenly they are no longer apologetic in their tacit support to BJP on the issue. "I have just one advice for CBI—work independently," says BJP leader Arun Jaitley. The Left's advice for the investigating agency may also come soon.

by Satarupa Bhattacharjya

SIGNPOSTS

QUASHED: By an Australian court, the Government's cancellation of Indian doctor Mohamed Haneef's **working visa** on complicity-in-terror charges.

WON: The **UN Grand Award** by an Indian public awareness campaign launched to encourage the use of condoms. The campaign, which used the slogan "Condom, *bindaas bol*" (Say condoms freely), was created to stem a decline in the sale and use of condoms in eight states of the north.



APPOINTED: Former Uttarakhand chief minister **N.D. Tiwari** as the

Andhra Pradesh governor. The Congress party had lost polls in the state earlier this year.

WON: The Rapid Chess Partnership by **Viswanathan Anand**. This is his 10th title at Mainz and seventh in succession at the German town after becoming the World Champion in 2000.

VIS-A-VIS J. JAYALALITHAA AIADMK supremo **versus** M. KARUNANIDHI Tamil Nadu chief minister

Let the days of your (Manmohan Singh) rule come to an end. Every additional day you are in power is a testing time for our sovereignty.



Her uncivilised statement only shows that she is like a frog in a well and is hardly aware of what is happening around her.

EPILOGUE: Politicians can never give up their games even if it is as serious an issue as energy security.